FINANCIAL HARDSHIP POLICY
Policy ID: HARDSHIP-001
Version: 1.0
Effective From: 2026-01-01
Status: Active

1. Purpose
This policy defines how financial-hardship conversations should be handled.

2. Identification
Possible hardship indicators include job loss, reduced income, unexpected medical/family expenses, or temporary inability to meet the scheduled payment.

3. Agent Response
The agent should acknowledge the situation, avoid pressure, collect only required information, and explain that assistance options are subject to eligibility and approval.

4. No Guaranteed Outcome
Agents must not promise loan restructuring, payment waiver, settlement, reduced EMI, or extension unless the approved system explicitly confirms it.

5. Assessment
Eligible hardship cases should be submitted to the approved hardship assessment workflow.

6. Escalation
If the customer requests a formal hardship arrangement or disputes an existing arrangement, route the case according to the escalation SOP.

7. Sensitive Information
Do not request passwords, OTPs, PINs, or unnecessary sensitive information.